

Delivery Record Fields for Contracted Compute

Fée-Fée Yang · Founder, PSYCHE · x.com/Undiscopurrr

August 2026

Two parties dispute a month. Each holds logs, each set is internally consistent, and neither can compel the other to accept its numbers. Six weeks later a figure is agreed on a call, and nobody writes down how it was reached.

Other markets settle this without asking anyone to be disinterested. A bill of lading is issued by the carrier, who is party to the contract of carriage and has an evident stake in what it says, and banks release payment against it under letters of credit all the same. It works because of when it is signed. At the moment of loading the carrier does not yet know whether the cargo will arrive damaged, whether the buyer will find a reason to refuse it, or which way its own interest will run, and a record made under that ignorance carries information no later account can supply.

Three properties do the work. Form is agreed beforehand, so the issuer cannot choose afterward what to set down and what to omit; the issuer signs, so revision becomes detectable; and the hour of signing is established by someone other than the signer, so neither of the first two can be defeated by a convenient clock.

Compute delivery has no disinterested observer, and at the volumes now under contract it will not acquire one. It can have a record with those three properties, filed by the parties themselves and checkable without either party's cooperation. One such record covers one delivery claim over one window.

A · Contract Standard

Evidence takes its meaning from the standard in force, so the standard travels with the record.

A1 · Obligation reference. The clause of the agreement this record answers to.

A2 · Metric definition. The quantity, its unit, and the function that turns samples into a period figure. Two parties averaging differently will produce different months from identical samples.

A3 · Measurement window. Start, end, offset, and the treatment of samples straddling either edge.

A4 · Exclusions. Conditions that do not count against the obligation, each with the evidence required to invoke it. An exclusion invoked after the window closes is an argument.

A5 · Tolerance and threshold. The shortfall that contributes nothing, and the level at which the obligation is missed.

A6 · Remedy schedule reference. The conversion from shortfall to money, held where the evaluation cannot read it.

A7 • Standard digest. A single commitment over A1 through A6, carried in an event that precedes the window. Without it, any of the six can be edited under an unchanged version number, rewriting the standard for months already closed.

B • Measurements

Both sides file. Operator telemetry and customer-side records arrive as separate submissions and stay separate.

B1 • Channel. The obligation this series measures.

B2 • Samples at the recorded interval. The series as the instrument produced it, ahead of any summary. A monthly figure that resists decomposition can only be accepted or refused.

B3 • Measured subject. The unit under measurement, at the grain the contract names: node, host, rack, cluster, endpoint. A customer who bought a rack and a clause that measures a host are describing different objects, and both instruments can be read correctly at the same time.

B4 • Measuring party and instrument. The party that took the reading, and what it read from.

B5 • Clock source and stated accuracy. Two logs that disagree about when will disagree about how much.

B6 • Aggregation applied before filing. Any downsampling between the instrument and this record, and the function it used.

C • Missing Intervals

Disagreement concentrates where one party has data and the other does not. An interval with no observation enters the record as a signed statement.

C1 • Interval. Start and end of the period without data.

C2 • Cause. As stated by the party holding the gap: instrument down, retention expired, collector restarted, never instrumented at all.

C3 • Attribution. The party whose evidence is absent.

C4 • Signature over C1 through C3. An unsigned gap is a blank, and a blank is filled by whichever party argues it better.

D • Provenance

Every filing is attributable to one party, and the record names the class of evidence it came from.

D1 • Filing party and signing key. One key per party. Nothing is filed on another party's behalf.

D2 • Source class. Operator-side, customer-side, hardware-attested, third-party-operated.

D3 • Independence. Whether two required sources share a trust root. Two readings from one root are one reading.

D4 • Signature over the filed set, algorithm named. Alteration after filing becomes detectable rather than deniable.

E • Temporal Binding

Everything above depends on when a record was made, and an interested party can claim any hour it likes.

E1 • Signing time as claimed. Necessary, and worth nothing by itself.

E2 • Inclusion proof against a published log head. A record inside a head published at time T existed before T, whatever its own clock asserted.

F • Claim and Decision

Two objects with different signers. One reports, the other decides.

F1 • Delivery claim. Units, window, standard, and evidence set. It carries no verdict and no settlement status.

F2 • Counterparty decision. Accept, reject, dispute, or abstain. Signed, attributable, and bound to the object it turns on. This field alone produces a settled state.

F3 • Authority reference. The grant F2 was signed under, and the limits of that grant. A signature given outside its grant binds no one, and the party that discovers this discovers it late.

Completeness

Give the record to someone who was absent and holds no account on either side. If the period figure, the shortfall and the amount owed all come out, and each traces to a named field, the record is complete. If any step wants a login, a phone call or a person's memory, what you have is a summary of an argument.

Completeness settles nothing. It puts one number and its basis in front of the party with authority to accept it.

The formal model and the invariants are in *Verification Is Not Acceptance*:

github.com/undiscoverrr/PSYCHE-PAPER

Where this list is under-specified for your fleet, tell me and I will fix it. If a closed case fails the test above, send it and I will reconstruct it.